



DNA loading on the drive... Complete

your? How closely do we want it to mimic real life?

There is an age-old saying that every coin has two sides. And, same is the case with metaverse too. While many talk about the positives and how transcending into a more connected and AR oriented world would benefit us. There are a select few who dare to look on the flipside and act upon what they are witnessing by making attempts to draft certain regulations. This brings us to the topic of laws and how they are and will be defined in the metaverse.

LAWS

Lawmakers across the world have been pushing for stricter privacy laws and data protection laws as we move towards a more connected world. However, the law is usually not able to keep pace with the advancements in technology. Laws written a hundred years ago, being interpreted by judges who are usually ignorant of modern technology, especially cutting edge technology, are rarely able to do a satisfactory job of justice when it comes to the digital world.

In a metaverse, leaving the policing of the place to the companies that run it (and more importantly, profit from it), is a recipe for disaster. Just look at how bad social media has been at regulating itself. Take Facebook for example, and how using a simple and seemingly harmless term like “silly goose”

can get you a warning and set the Facebook bots on to you. They will then start monitoring your posts and suddenly you start getting warnings for random things you might have said many times before, and even get bans. Meanwhile, there are others around you who you will notice are spreading false information, saying terribly hateful things and generally spouting venom and they're never warned or stopped. Why? Because if Facebook were to truly try and make its platform a place void of insensitivity and foul language, they're scared people would stop using it and jump on to other platforms that are less regulated.

And by no means do we mean to single out Facebook, all the big tech firms are no different, and will always put profit before what's right or moral, because the financial system is designed that way.

Now let's jump to a metaverse example of NFTs. One of the ways in which the value of NFTs makes sense, as do the value of most digital art that's sold that way, is if it will be unique in the metaverse. Of course there are no laws yet to govern what is “unique” when it comes to the digital world of NFTs. And of course NFTs are not truly unique. For example, we could put the covers of Digit Magazines up for sale on an NFT platform, and yes, those would be sold once, for those specific files with that specific hash. But nothing

stops us from framing those covers in a different way and uploading those same covers again, and selling them again. And what if someone scanned their own Digit magazine cover (the physical magazine they bought), and uploaded that into their own metaverse profile as an asset. Can we stop them? Can we claim that it is our copyright and no one but us can use that imagery? Would it be right to? After all, they did buy that magazine. And if we used a particular image from a stock photo service for the cover. Do we have rights to upload that in the metaverse as our own?

There are no answers to these questions right now, and certainly no laws for them at the moment. One would need to take it to a court and fight an expensive court case in order to set some precedent in the courts for it to even be considered by the legal system. Will there be metacourts that exist only in the metaverse, and will admins of little meta fiefdoms dress themselves up as judges to preside over the hearings of such disputes in the metaverse? Only time will tell. Though if you're buying up a lot of



Is it a crime? ...Is it not?

NFTs now, in order to be able to sell them to the masses on the metaverse later, you're either a genius or a fool, and for that as well, only time will tell.

Finally, how on earth the metaverse will deal with physical boundaries is a problem that will escalate as well. It already exists in the standard internet as of today, with internet companies having to follow norms and laws based on which country their users reside in. This is a problem that will continue to plague the metaverse. And if, as we expect, crime will increase with the increasing complexity of the metaverse, these problems will too! 